PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | CrowdStrike | SIEM/SOAR | EDR | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience in cyber security engineering, specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) operations, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) technologies, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR). Currently serving as Senior Cyber Security Engineer at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I bring expert-level proficiency with CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules across an enterprise estate of over 8,000 users. I have a strong track record of reducing alert noise through SOAR automation, leading Security Operations Centre (SOC) investigations aligned to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, and delivering measurable improvement in threat detection and response times. I hold deep experience with Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Azure Active Directory / Entra ID identity controls. I am well-versed in Mimecast email security, Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, and firewall management through Check Point Harmony. I am seeking to bring this depth of operational expertise to a high-performing, close-knit security engineering team within financial services.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** Next-Generation SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover - Expert
- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), Kusto Query Language (KQL), SOAR automation and playbook development
- **Microsoft Defender:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Okta (familiarity)
- **Email Security:** Mimecast email security platform
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Palo Alto (familiarity)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Bash, Python (familiarity)
- **Endpoint Management:** Tanium, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Frameworks:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Engineer

- Lead the operation and optimisation of CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM and EDR across an estate of over 8,000 users, including the Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules, tuning detection policies to reduce false-positive alert volume by over 40%.
- Design, build, and maintain SOAR automation playbooks integrated with Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert triage, accelerating mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-severity incidents from hours to under 30 minutes.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and KQL queries within Microsoft Sentinel, identifying and containing threats before escalation using MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques as a detection framework.
- Manage SIEM alert triage and incident escalation workflows, operating as the primary analyst for Tier 2 and Tier 3 incidents in alignment with NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle (Preparation, Detection, Containment,

Eradication, Recovery).

- Administer Mimecast email security, developing and refining policies to detect and block phishing, Business Email Compromise (BEC), and malware delivery campaigns.
- Govern identity security controls across Azure AD / Entra ID, including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), MFA enforcement, and SSO integrations, reducing identity-based attack surface for over 8,000 accounts.
- Oversee BeyondTrust PAM for privileged account governance, managing secure remote access, session recording, and least-privilege enforcement across administrative accounts.
- Lead vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera BAS, and AppCheck, prioritising remediation by business risk and tracking progress against CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Manage Check Point Harmony firewall rules, reviewing and rationalising policies in line with network segmentation and zero-trust security principles.
- Provide senior-level guidance on security incidents to IT leadership, producing post-incident reports with root-cause analysis and improvement recommendations.

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Performed SIEM alert triage and investigation using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, responding to Tier 1 and Tier 2 security events across the UAL estate.
- Authored KQL-based detection rules and hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel to identify anomalous behaviour, lateral movement, and credential-based attacks.
- Supported the deployment and rollout of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) as part of a university-wide Microsoft 365 Defender adoption programme.
- Managed Entra ID (Azure AD) user and group lifecycle, enforcing Conditional Access policies and MFA across staff and student populations.
- Administered Mimecast email security, creating and refining policies to block malicious attachments, URLs, and impersonation attempts.
- Conducted regular vulnerability scans using Tenable.io and Nessus, reporting findings to IT infrastructure teams and tracking remediation through a defined risk-based process.
- Supported the BeyondTrust PAM platform, onboarding privileged accounts and ensuring least-privilege access controls were enforced for administrative staff.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns, improving staff reporting rates and reducing click-through rates on simulated phishing exercises.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus audit preparation, compiling evidence packs and supporting internal and external audit teams.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security operations for a SaaS and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment, maintaining endpoint security controls, patch management, and network access policies.
- Implemented and administered identity and access management controls across cloud and on-premises systems, including MFA and role-based access control (RBAC).
- Conducted security monitoring and alert response, investigating endpoint and network anomalies and escalating confirmed incidents to senior engineers.
- Supported infrastructure quality assurance processes and contributed to disaster recovery testing and business continuity planning.
- Managed IT infrastructure including server maintenance, network configuration, and endpoint provisioning for a growing SaaS organisation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-severity incidents from over four hours to under 30 minutes through SOAR automation and CrowdStrike Falcon playbook development.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an estate of over 8,000 users, significantly improving endpoint and identity threat visibility.

- Reduced false-positive CrowdStrike Falcon EDR alert volume by over 40% through policy tuning, detection rule refinement, and exclusion management.
- Led the design and deployment of BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) across UAL, centralising privileged account governance and eliminating shared admin credentials.
- Successfully supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus certification and renewal for UAL, coordinating evidence collection and audit responses across the Cyber Security and Identity team.
- Implemented Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and AppCheck vulnerability scanning, establishing a continuous threat exposure management programme aligned to the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF).

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)